

RESERVE NETWORK STUDY

One network across the whole reserve.

We modelled Sibuya's terrain from satellite elevation data and checked every radio path against it. two ridge high-sites give line of sight across 77% of the reserve, fed from a carrier uplink on Kenton-on-Sea high ground.

Prepared for

Kyle Dickie, Sibuya Game Reserve

Prepared by

Gerhard Smit, CTTX Services (Pty) Ltd

Date

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--- Carrier uplink — Private backbone — Lodge link

■ Clear line of sight for a 3 m field terminal

Sentinel-2 imagery, 5 August 2026. The dotted outline is the study area around the lodges. Site positions are desktop candidates, to be confirmed on a site visit.

77%

of the reserve area in
line of sight

2 + 0

ridge high-sites plus
short relays

77%

of the 34 km² study
area in line of sight

6.2 km

clear carrier uplink into
the reserve

01

Where things stand today

Sibuya runs three camps on 3,000 ha along the Kariega River, reached by boat rather than road. A property that no road-based provider will build to needs its own backbone: one owned network that crosses the river and reaches the camps and the field.

WHAT THE PUBLIC RECORD SHOWS

3

02

Carrier in, private network out

Carrier connectivity comes into the reserve once. Everything past that point runs on infrastructure the reserve owns.

LAYER 1 · CARRIER

Uplink from Kenton-on-Sea high ground

An uncontended business-grade Vodacom service, delivered by CTTX over a 6.2 km link to High Site East. LTE failover keeps the reserve connected if the carrier path drops.

LAYER 2 · BACKBONE

Ridge high-sites

High Site West (98 m) and High Site East (151 m) sit 3.0 km apart with a clear link between them. Each site runs on solar and lithium storage with remote monitoring, so the network stays up through load-shedding.

LAYER 3 · DISTRIBUTION

Every lodge and ops site

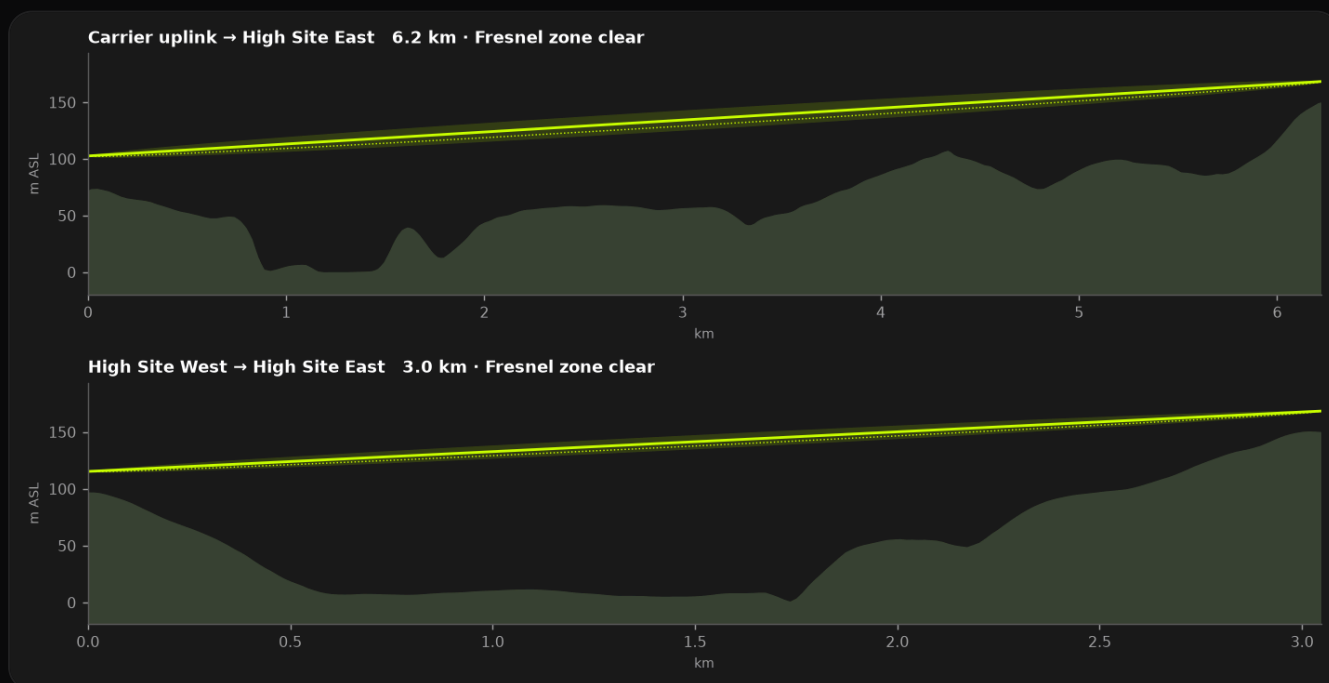
Sector radios reach the lodges, HQ, the anti-poaching base, ecology, the workshop and the gates. A LoRaWAN gateway is ready for fence, water-point, pump and fuel sensors.

BUILT FOR WHAT COMES NEXT

Once the backbone covers the reserve, a new camera, sensor or lodge is an endpoint on a network that is already there. It is not a new infrastructure project or a new provider contract.

03 Every path checked against the terrain

Each profile shows the ground between two sites, the radio path (lime line) and its Fresnel zone (lime band). We allow for earth curvature and require at least 60% of the zone to be clear at every point. A path that fails is not drawn.



LODGE	SERVED FROM	PATH LENGTH	LINE OF SIGHT
Forest Camp	—	—	POSITION TO CONFIRM
River Camp	—	—	POSITION TO CONFIRM
Bush Lodge	—	—	POSITION TO CONFIRM

Entries marked “position to confirm” have no published location. We add them to the model once you share a marked map or KMZ.

5.8 GHz · k = 4/3 · uplink tower 30 m · high-site masts 18 m · lodge masts 8 m. Lodge positions come from published GPS coordinates.

04

One backbone for every driver of the business

A reserve network carries three loads at once. This design is built to hold all three on one backbone.

GUEST EXPERIENCE

Reliable Wi-Fi, booking and card payments at every lodge.

STAFF COMMUNICATION

Lodges, HQ, rangers and maintenance on one network, day and night.

SECURITY AND OPERATIONS

Cameras, gates, fence alarms and sensors on the same backbone, powered through load-shedding.

05

What other properties got back

Sandymount Safaris 30,000+ ha, three lodges

BEFORE

A consumer wireless service at about 3 Mbps down and 8 Mbps up, with the provider on site daily to swap IPs and reinstall equipment.

AFTER

A Vodacom-backed 100 Mbps symmetrical link into the reserve, a CTTX-built main mast and two secondary masts, solar and lithium power, all monitored remotely.

GUEST EXPERIENCE

HD sport streams live at the lodges. Guest connectivity is no longer something the lodges think about.

STAFF COMMUNICATION

Over 800 Mbps measured across the reserve's own backbone, linking the main lodge, Mountain Retreat and Samar.

SECURITY AND OPERATIONS

Daily provider callouts went to zero. Every fault used to need a vehicle and a person; now the network is monitored remotely.

OWNERSHIP

The reserve keeps adding systems on top of the backbone. In the client's words, they stopped doing speed tests.

WHEN THE NETWORK GOES QUIET AFTER HOURS

Elephants broke out after 21:00 and staff had no effective way to coordinate. The requirement that came out of it: dependable communications after hours, across the areas where an incident can happen.

An Eastern Cape lodge near Addo

OWNING THE NETWORK PAYS FOR ITSELF

Replacing a rented, contended service and rented Wi-Fi with a lodge-owned network breaks even in under three years on connectivity savings alone. It also connects areas the old setup never reached, including the spa.

The same lodge, business case from its own invoices (Sep 2026)

06

What it pays back

A reserve that replaces a separate rented connection and rented Wi-Fi at every lodge with one owned backbone typically recovers the investment in under three years on connectivity costs alone. The security, operations and guest-experience benefits come on top of that.

YOUR NUMBER, NOT OURS

Send us each lodge's latest connectivity invoice, or just the monthly totals, and we will work out Sibuya's actual payback. It takes us a day.

If infrastructure decisions sit with someone else, please pass this on. Owners will find the payback and ownership case, the reserve manager the security and operations case, and lodge managers the guest experience case.

07

What changes when the reserve owns it

TODAY

3

WITH A RESERVE BACKBONE

- One uncontended carrier feed shared across the reserve
- Lodges, HQ, the anti-poaching base and gates on one private network
- Coverage out into the field, day and night
- An owned asset that takes cameras and sensors without new towers

Avoided loss

Sibuya is a Big Five reserve with rhino and a documented poaching history. A backbone that reaches the camps, the river crossings and the rangers is what lets the reserve see and respond to an incident, day and night.

Operational efficiency

Water points, pumps and fuel tanks report their own status, so there are fewer vehicle trips just to check. Maintenance, ecology and lodges share one communications path.

Infrastructure ownership

High sites, backbone and power belong to the reserve. The network grows with the reserve instead of depending on each lodge's separate provider.

Executive risk reduction

Management gets live visibility of the network, cameras and sensors, and a record of operational diligence for owners, insurers and conservation partners.

1

30-minute call

Your lodges' current connectivity costs, your peak usage, the incidents that were hardest to coordinate, and what currently needs a vehicle trip to check.

2

Confirm the sites

A marked map of HQ, the anti-poaching base and the gates. We add them to the model and rerun the link plan.

3

One day on the reserve

We walk the high sites and relay points, and confirm the carrier uplink with Vodacom.

4

Design and proposal

A final design in Cambium LINKPlanner, with equipment, power, a phased plan and the investment case.

Method. Terrain: Copernicus DEM GLO-30 (30 m). Imagery: ESA Sentinel-2 L2A true colour, 5 August 2026. Radio model: 5.8 GHz, effective earth radius factor 4/3, 60% first-Fresnel-zone clearance at every point. The terrain model does not include trees or buildings. Every path is confirmed on survey before anything is built.

Candidate positions. High Site East -33.62089, 26.66665; High Site West -33.60917, 26.63694; carrier uplink -33.67689, 26.66255 (Kenton-on-Sea high ground). The exact carrier site is subject to Vodacom feasibility.

Gerhard Smit

CTTX Services (Pty) Ltd

Tel 084 550 3281

Email gerhard@cttx.co.za

Web cttx.co.za